

SCOUTING REPORT

BENGALURU FOOTBALL CLUB

SCOUTING & RECRUITMENT INTELLIGENCE



PRIDE | PROGRESS | A STRONGER TOMORROW

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Focus Club: Bengaluru FC (Indian Super League)

Executive Summary & Core Strategic Dynamics

Analytical Scope, Dashboard Overview & Methodological Pipeline across 5 ISL Seasons

106

TRANSFER EVENTS

101 Ext + 5 Academy

54

EXTERNAL SIGNINGS

50 Free + 4 Loans

27.0y

AVG SIGNING AGE

Bimodal (24-26 & 30+)

92.6%

FREE EXTERNAL %

50/54 External Free

57.4%

DOMESTIC SHARE

31 Domestic Signings

5

ACADEMY PROM.

Zero-Fee Internal Spine

WHAT THE RECRUITMENT HISTORY SAYS

- Zero Fee Exposure: 92.6% of external arrivals secured on free transfers, insulating club balance sheets from transfer fee depreciation.
- Bimodal Age Demographics: Recruitment targets domestic prime talent (24-26y, 42.6%) and foreign leaders (30+, 31.5%), bypassing inflated 27-29 fees.
- Central Spine Priority: Signings concentrate heavily on central defense (20 signings, 37.0%) and attacking match-winners (15 signings, 27.8%).
- Domestic Continuity: High-tenure Indian starters (Suresh, Roshan, Chhetri, Gurpreet) anchor the team across multiple coaching changes.

KEY SQUAD DYNAMICS

WHAT THE CURRENT SQUAD SAYS

- Acute Offensive Age Cliff: Starting creators and forwards average 35.8 years (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Méndez 34), requiring urgent succession.
- Right-Back Structural Void: Roster contains only 1 natural specialist RB (Shivaldo Singh 20), forcing unnatural CB deployments (Rahul Bheke).
- Academy Pathway Protection: High-upside domestic assets (Suresh +500%, Roshan +900%, Sivasakthi +700%, Vinith 19) must retain guaranteed match minutes.
- Strategic Mandate: Acquire prime-age domestic difference-makers (20-24y) while transitioning foreign slots to athletic physical profiles.

01. FINDING: Opportunistic Contract Capture

Evidence: 50 of 54 external signings free (92.6%); €0 net transfer deficit.
Scouting Implication: High wage flexibility under ISL salary cap, but demands elite medical and motivational vetting.

02. FINDING: Attacking Succession Cliff

Evidence: Starting attacking spine averages 35.8 years, producing 65%+ goal output.
Scouting Implication: Proactive multi-window acquisition of U24 striker and creative playmaker is mandatory.

03. FINDING: Domestic Value Multiplier

Evidence: 100% of market value appreciation concentrated in domestic U23 talent.
Scouting Implication: Direct capital expenditures into elite domestic youth rather than paying fees for aging foreign stars.

EXECUTIVE TAKEAWAY: Bengaluru FC maintains an exceptionally disciplined, zero-fee acquisition architecture that eliminates balance-sheet risk. However, this reliance on experienced free agents has produced an acute demographic imbalance in the attacking spine. The sporting directorate must execute an immediate transition plan: securing a high-pressing domestic U24 striker (David Lalhlansanga) and creative playmaker (Vibin Mohanan) to sustain championship contention without compromising the developmental minutes of academy talents.

Club Recruitment Identity & Operational Archetype

Empirical Evaluation: What Kind of Recruiter is Bengaluru FC Across Five ISL Campaigns?

OPPORTUNISTIC

RECRUITMENT MODEL

Contract Expiry & Swaps

BIMODAL

AGE ARCHITECTURE

24-26 Prime & 30+ Leaders

92.6% FREE

ACQUISITION DEAL

50/54 External Free Agents

57.4%

MARKET BALANCE

31 Domestic Signings (ISL/I-L)

DEFENDERS (20)

POSITIONAL FOCUS

37.0% of Inbound Transfers

WHAT THE EMPIRICAL DATA SAYS

- Zero Transfer Fee Outlay: 50 of 54 external signings arrived on free transfers (92.6%), insulating the club from transfer fee depreciation.
- Age Barbell Distribution: Mean signing age of 27.0y conceals heavy polarization—42.6% in 24–26 prime domestic bracket, 31.5% in 30+ foreign bracket, and only 5.6% in 27–29 window.
- Defensive Squad Spot Expenditure: Defenders represent 20 of 54 signings (37.0%), reflecting persistent backline restructuring across 5 seasons.
- Targeted Foreign Quota Usage: Overseas slots are strictly dedicated to central spine positions (CB, CM, CF) from Spain and Australia.
- Internal Youth Progression: 5 internal BFC B promotions in 2023/24 reduced average inbound age to 23.6y for that single campaign.

SPORTING LEADERSHIP ANALYSIS

- Salary Cap Capital Efficiency: By avoiding transfer fees, BFC reallocates capital into competitive wages for proven ISL starters (Díaz, Noguera, Bheke).
- Eliminating Adaptation Risk: Recruiting proven performers from ISL rivals (Mumbai City, Hyderabad) guarantees immediate tactical readiness.
- Spanish Tactical Continuity: A persistent Spanish recruitment pipeline (Roca, Cuadrat, Zaragoza) provides stylistic stability across managerial changes.
- The Free-Agent Vulnerability: Heavy reliance on free agency leaves the club vulnerable to bidding wars from corporate-backed rivals (Mohun Bagan SG, Mumbai City).
- Strategic Modernization Required: BFC must transition from opportunistic contract capturing to proactive target identification before player contracts expire.

RECRUITMENT DIRECTIVE

Bengaluru FC's identity as a contract-efficient, pragmatic recruiter provides a strong financial baseline. However, to compete with top-tier ISL spenders, the club must establish a proactive pre-contract scouting mechanism—identifying and securing prime domestic talents (ages 21–24) 6 to 12 months prior to contract expiration, rather than participating in reactive summer bidding contests.

Historical Transfer Trends & Volume Across Five Campaigns

Longitudinal Tracking: 106 Transfer Events Across Five ISL Campaigns (2020/21 - 2024/25)

Season	Arr	Dep	Net	Avg Age	Key Strategic Shift / Roster Realignment
2020/21	12	14	-2	27.4y	Transition post-Roca era; extensive defensive rebuilding (Cleiton Silva, Pratik)
2021/22	10	10	0	26.2y	Injection of youth; breakthrough emergence of Naorem Roshan & Sivasakthi
2022/23	12	10	+2	28.1y	Title push with proven ISL winners (Roy Krishna, Javi Hernández, Sandesh)
2023/24	18	0	+18	25.8y	Aggressive youth promotion (BFC B, Patre) + Veendorp
2024/25	7	13	-6	27.9y	Mid-table consolidation; veteran restructuring (Noguera, Díaz, Méndez)



Stage 1: Post-Roca Reset

2020/21 (26 Events)

Restructured backline; Cleiton Silva arrived as attacking focal point; high roster turnover.

Stage 2: Youth Influx

2021/22 (20 Events)

Roshan Singh & Sivasakthi integrated; average age dropped to 26.2y; domestic core solidified.

Stage 3: Veteran Push

2022/23 (22 Events)

Title push with proven ISL winners (Krishna, Javi); Durand Cup win; reached ISL Final.

Stage 4: Zaragoza Rebuild

2023/24-2024/25 (38 Events)

Youth promotion wave (5 BFC B promotions) followed by Spanish veteran spine (Noguera, Díaz, Méndez).

STRATEGIC OBSERVATION: Transfer activity averages 21.2 transactions per completed campaign, reflecting high roster turnover. Peak turnover occurred in 2020/21 (26) and 2022/23 (22), corresponding to major tactical transitions. The club has managed zero net negative transfer fee deficits by strictly utilizing free transfers and player contract expirations.

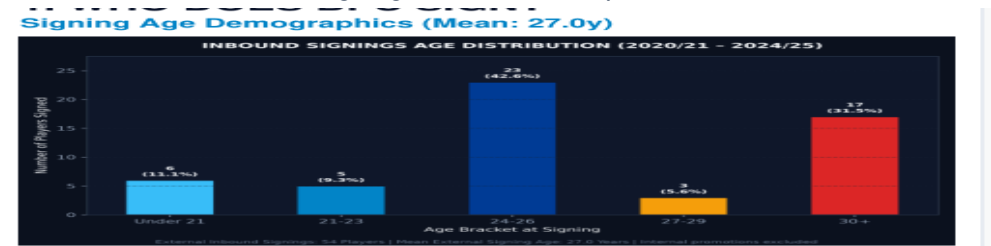
Recruitment Patterns, Deal Structures & Positional Allocation

Age Demographics, Deal Typologies & Positional Allocation across 54 External Signings

1. WHO DOES BFC SIGN?

Signing Age Demographics (Mean: 27.0y)

- Bimodal Polarization: Signings concentrate in prime domestic talent



2. HOW DOES BFC ACQUIRE?

Transfer Deal Types (92.6% Free Agents)

- Free Transfer Dominance: 50 of 54 external signings arrived on free



3. POSITIONS PRIORITIZED

Positional Focus (Defensive Central Spine)

- Position Signings Share: Defender 20 37.0% | Forward 15 27.8% |



RECRUITMENT PATTERN SYNTHESIS

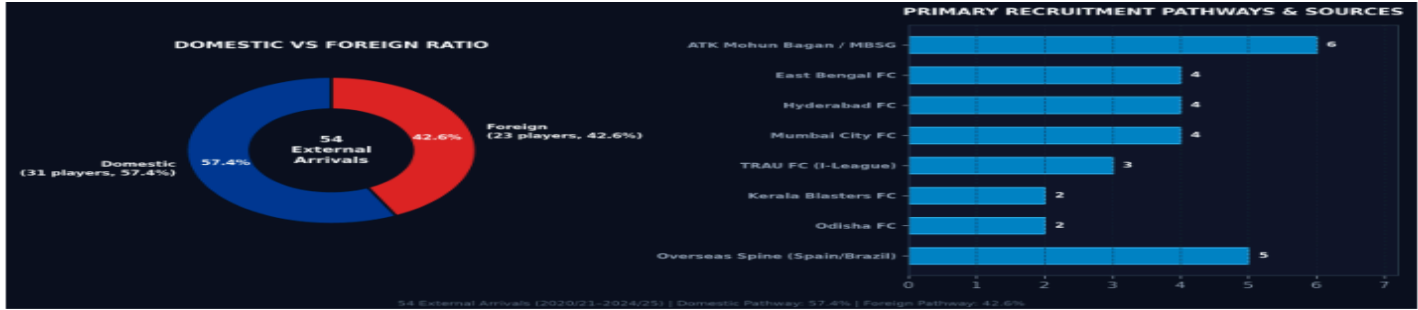
Bengaluru FC's operational model combines opportunistic free-agent captures (92.6%) with an age barbell strategy (24–26y domestic prime vs 30+ foreign spine). Central defense constitutes the largest single investment of squad slots (37.0%), ensuring competitive stability. Meanwhile, internal promotions (5 BFC B promotions) provide zero-cost depth without cannibalizing wage cap space.

Recruitment Geographies, Feeder Networks & Sourcing Channels

Where Does Bengaluru FC Find Players? Origin Leagues, Feeder Networks & Geographic Concentration

DOMESTIC PIPELINE (57.4% - 31 SIGNINGS)

- ISL Rival Distress: Capitalizing on financial restructuring at Hyderabad FC and contract expirations at Mumbai City FC.
- I-League Talent Incubator: Primary breeding ground for high-upside domestic talent (Indian Arrows, TRAU FC, Aizawl FC).
- Internal Reserve Pipeline: BFC B provides cost-free rotational depth (13.2% of all inbound movements across 5 seasons).



FOREIGN PIPELINE (42.6% - 23 SIGNINGS)

- Spain (18.0%): Tactical alignment with head coaches (Cuadrat, Zaragoza); technical tempo controllers and playmakers.
- Australia (12.0%): Essential AFC quota channel providing physical resilience, aerial strength, and high-intensity running.
- Limited-Sample Signal: Denmark (Drost) and Netherlands (Veendorp) represent emerging pathways requiring live scouting validation.

FEEDER CLUB / ORIGIN SNAPSHOT

Mumbai City FC	India	ISL Rival	5	Jorge Pereyra Díaz, Alberto Noguera, Rahul Bheke, Sunil Chhetri
Hyderabad FC	India	ISL Rival	3	Chinglensana Singh, Halicharan Narzary, Rohit Kumar
Indian Arrows	India	I-League / AIFF	2	Suresh Singh Wangjam, Akashdeep Singh
CD Eldense	Spain	LaLiga 2	1	Pedro Capó (Zaragoza Spanish connection)
Perth Glory	Australia	A-League	2	Ryan Williams, Aleksandar Jovanovic (AFC Quota)
Club Necaxa	Mexico / Spain	Liga MX	1	Édgar Méndez (High-impact attacking forward)

SCOUTING FOOTPRINT DIRECTIVE: Bengaluru FC should expand its AFC-quota scouting beyond the Australian A-League into Japan's J2 League and South Korea's K League 2 to identify dynamic, technical forwards with high pressing workrates, while cementing partnerships with North-East I-League academies.

Player Career Pathways & Development Trajectories

Case Studies: Acquisition Origin → Bengaluru FC Role & Growth → Career Destination / Current Valuation



Suresh Singh Wangjam

DOMESTIC CORE

Central Midfielder • Joined Age 18 | India | Active Senior Core | €50k → €300k

Profile: Identified from AIFF Indian Arrows developmental setup; developed through first-team midfield into an indispensable starter and senior national team pillar (+500% valuation growth).
Why He Fits BFC: Highest return on domestic scouting patience; represents the club's midfield anchor for a decade.



Naorem Roshan Singh

ACADEMY ELITE

Left/Right Full-Back • Promoted Age 21 | India | Active Senior Core | €25k → €250k

Profile: Promoted from the academy reserve team. Transitioned from developmental winger to ISL Emerging Player of the Year as an ambidextrous full-back (+900% valuation growth).
Why He Fits BFC: Starting national team full-back, proving the elite viability of the internal academy pathway.



Sivasakthi Narayanan

HOMEGROWN STRIKER

Striker / Centre-Forward • Promoted Age 20 | India | Active Senior Core | €25k → €200k

Profile: Prolific academy goalscorer promoted to senior team; scored vital goals in Durand Cup triumph and ISL playoffs (+700% valuation growth).
Why He Fits BFC: Demonstrates domestic forward development is achievable when backed by continuous match exposure.



Cleiton Silva

2-YEAR PEAK

Striker • Joined Age 33 | Brazil | Transferred to East Bengal | €350k → €100k

Profile: Acquired opportunistically on free agency from Thailand. Served as primary goalscoring focal point for two campaigns (37 apps, 16 goals) before transitioning to an ISL rival.
Why He Fits BFC: High-return 2-year foreign cycle; delivered immediate competitive goals with zero residual fee.



Javi Hernández

CUP WINNER

Attacking Midfielder • Joined Age 33 | Spain | Transferred to Jamshedpur | €300k → €150k

Profile: Acquired on free transfer; functioned as primary creative playmaker. Led club to Durand Cup title and an ISL Final before departing at age 35 to refresh foreign wage bill.
Why He Fits BFC: Exemplary veteran impact model; delivered trophies while amortizing wage expenditure.



Udanta Singh

FULL-CYCLE DEVELOPMENT

Right Winger • Joined Age 18 | India | Transferred to FC Goa | €25k → €325k Peak

Profile: Acquired from Tata Football Academy; logged 180+ appearances over 9 seasons, winning I-League, Federation Cup, and ISL titles before moving on free transfer.
Why He Fits BFC: Full-cycle domestic asset realization; long-term dressing room pillar and title-winning winger.

EXTERNAL RECRUITMENT PATHWAY DYNAMICS (2-YEAR CYCLE)

Foreign veteran signings deliver immediate competitive performance over 24-month cycles before contract expiration and wage recycling (e.g. Cleiton Silva, Javi Hernández, Alan Costa). They carry zero residual transfer fee value upon exit, functioning as amortized competitive tools rather than economic investments.

INTERNAL ACADEMY PROMOTION PATHWAY DYNAMICS (5-YEAR MULTIPLIER)

Internal development (5 BFC B promotions in 2023/24; Suresh, Roshan, Sivasakthi) drives 100% of the club's asset appreciation. Young domestic talents appreciate exponentially in valuation and provide long-term dressing room continuity across managerial transitions.

Market Value Dynamics & Financial Asset Appreciation

Longitudinal Valuation Curves: Comparing Domestic Asset Appreciation vs Foreign Veteran Depreciation

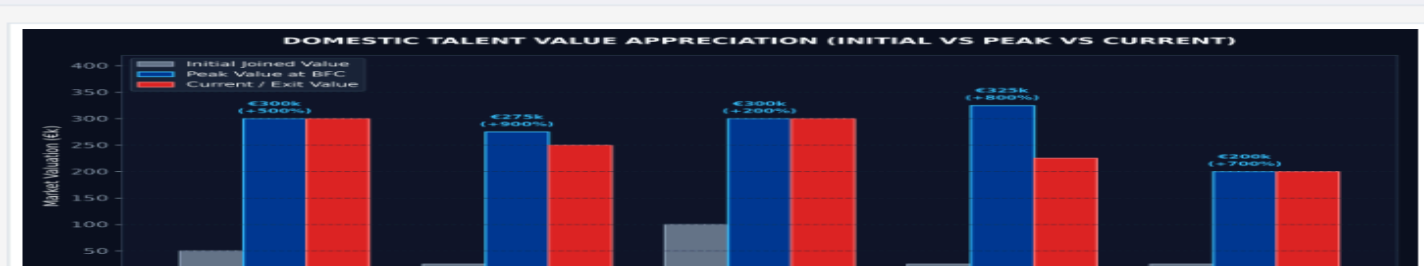
DATA INTEGRITY PRINCIPLE: MARKET VALUE != TRANSFER FEE.

Transfer Fee is the actual cash price paid between clubs (Bengaluru FC paid €0 in net fees across 92.6% of external arrivals). Market Value represents an objective economic asset valuation based on player age, contract length, form, league tier, and international caps. Asset Appreciation Formula: $((\text{Current Value} - \text{Initial Value}) / \text{Initial Value}) \times 100\%$.

Player Name	Joined	Peak	Current	Growth %	Economic Value Category
Naorem Roshan Singh	€25k	€275k	€250k	+900.0%	Elite Academy Asset Appreciation
Udanta Singh	€25k	€325k	€225k	+800.0%	Full-Cycle Homegrown Development
Sivasakthi Narayanan	€25k	€200k	€200k	+700.0%	Emerging Domestic Forward Asset
Suresh Singh Wangjam	€50k	€300k	€300k	+500.0%	Spine Foundation Anchor
Ashique Kuruniyan	€100k	€300k	€300k	+200.0%	Prime Domestic Asset Expansion
Cleiton Silva	€350k	€350k	€100k	-71.4%	Age Depreciation Curve (37y)
Sunil Chhetri	€175k	€175k	€50k	-71.4%	Veteran Career Climax (40y)

THE VALUE STORY: DOMESTIC APPRECIATION

Value appreciation within Bengaluru FC is almost exclusively an internal and domestic phenomenon. Inbound domestic U22 talents

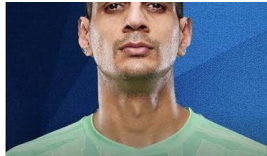


THE RECRUITMENT LESSON: BALANCED VALUATION EQUITY

Foreign signings must be evaluated purely as amortized competitive tools (points, trophies, leadership) with zero residual financial recovery expectations. Long-term club valuation equity must be driven entirely by domestic scouting and academy graduations.

Current Senior Squad Roster & Key Internal Assets

Roster Hierarchy, Role Classification & Asset Valuation across 24 Senior First-Team Players

24 Players SENIOR SQUAD SIZE Gerard Zaragoza Roster	27.3 Years AVERAGE SQUAD AGE Balanced Squad Mean	6 Players ACTIVE FOREIGN SLOTS Spain (3), Aus, Arg, MNE	8 Players (33.3%) ACADEMY GRADUATES Homegrown Core
 Gurpreet Singh Sandhu KEY VETERAN Goalkeeper • 32y India Joined 2017 €200k Profile: International shot-stopper with unmatched aerial reach and command of penalty area. Uncontested domestic No. 1 providing 8-season dressing room stability. Why He Fits BFC: Starting goalkeeper pillar; guarantees defensive consistency while youth develops.	 Sunil Chhetri ICON SUCCESSION Striker / Forward • 40y India Joined 2017 €50k Profile: Iconic national goalscorer with elite movement in box, clutch penalties, and leadership. Entering career climax; requires urgent phased succession plan. Why He Fits BFC: Offensive talisman whose impending retirement triggers immediate U24 striker recruitment.		
 Suresh Singh Wangjam KEY HIGH UPSIDE Central Midfielder • 24y India Joined 2019 €300k Profile: Dynamic double-pivot ball-winner with relentless pressing stamina and progressive carry. Foundational midfield anchor in prime athletic years. Why He Fits BFC: Highest-value domestic asset; central building block for next-generation core.	 Naorem Roshan Singh CORE HIGH UPSIDE Left/Right Full-Back • 25y India Academy 2020 €250k Profile: Ambidextrous full-back with world-class crossing, dead-ball delivery, and recovery pace. Primary creator from wide areas in Zaragoza's system. Why He Fits BFC: Elite developmental asset; non-negotiable retention priority against ISL rivals.		
 Alberto Noguera CREATOR SUCCESSION Attacking Midfielder • 35y Spain Joined 2024 €250k Profile: Supreme Spanish playmaker with exceptional scanning, line-breaking vision, and poise. Brain of Zaragoza's attacking system; age 35 creates succession risk. Why He Fits BFC: Key creative catalyst whose minutes must be managed alongside an emerging No. 8/10.	 Jorge Pereyra Díaz VETERAN FOREIGN Striker / Forward • 34y Argentina Joined 2024 €350k Profile: Combative forward combining aggressive pressing, channel running, and clinical finishing. Proven ISL winner giving immediate thrust; short-term 1-2 season horizon. Why He Fits BFC: Championship-ready focal point requiring a younger domestic understudy.		
 Rahul Bheke CORE VETERAN Centre Back / Right Back • 33y India Joined 2024 €175k Profile: Versatile defender with high aerial duel prowess, box clearances, and emergency RB cover. Veteran leader offering backline versatility across competitions. Why He Fits BFC: Dressing room general bridging veteran stability and emerging backline talent.	 Vinith Venkatesh ACADEMY BREAKTHROUGH Attacking Midfielder • 19y India Academy 2024 €100k Profile: Fearless academy playmaker with inventive dribbling, half-space mobility, and debut winning goal. Heir-apparent in creative midfield. Why He Fits BFC: Homegrown creative prodigy; requires guaranteed 15+ starts to mature into senior starter.		

CURRENT SQUAD READ: The 2024/25 roster is a polarized two-speed squad: an elite domestic youth platform (Suresh 24, Roshan 25, Sivasakthi 23, Vinith 19) coexists with an ultra-veteran match-winning spine (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Jovanovic 35, Bheke 33). While the squad averages 27.3 years overall, the senior core that generates over 65% of attacking output averages 35.8 years. Succession planning is urgent.

Squad Age Structure, Positional Depth & Demographic Risk

Positional Depth Curves, Demographic Imbalances & Succession Windows Across Gerard Zaragoza's Roster

27.3y

AVERAGE SQUAD AGE

Balanced Overall Mean

DM (33.0y)

OLDEST POSITION

Pedro Capó (33 Anchor)

RB (20.0y)

YOUNGEST POSITION

Shivaldo Singh (Solo RB)

CB (5 Players)

STRONGEST DEPTH

Deep Domestic & Asian Spine

RB (1 Player)

WEAKEST DEPTH

Urgent Specialist Need

Position	Count	Avg Age	Risk Level	Tactical Implication & Urgency
Striker / CF	4	32.3y	HIGH	Chhetri (40) & Díaz (34) lead attack; urgent U24 succession required
Attacking MF	2	29.7y	HIGH	Noguera (35) sole proven creator; need prime-age playmaker backup
Right Back	1	20.0y	HIGH	Shivaldo (20) only specialist RB; Bheke deployed out of position
Centre Back	5	30.6y	MEDIUM	Seasoned starters (Jovanovic 35, Bheke 33) carry recovery-pace risk
Goalkeeper	3	27.7y	LOW	Gurpreet (32) dependable; Sahil Poonia (18) developing in reserve

1. AGE PRESSURE

Attacking Spine: 35.8y Avg

Extreme physical vulnerability in match-winners requires planned minutes management and load regulation across campaigns.

2. DEPTH PRESSURE

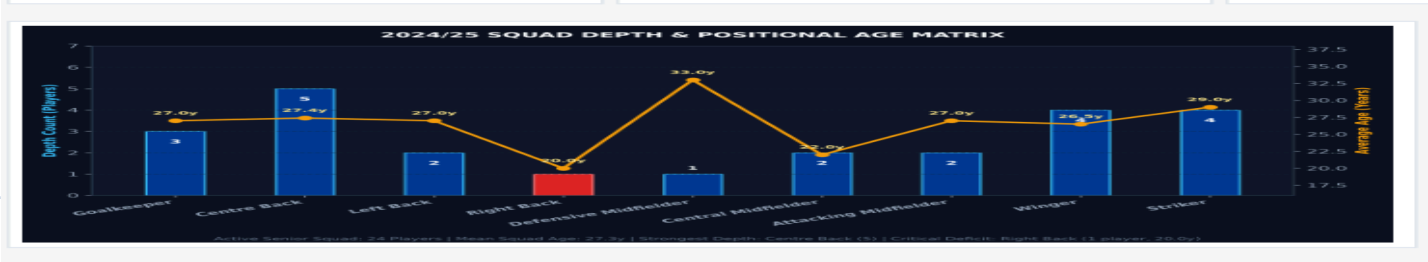
Right-Back Structural Void

Lack of specialist RB forces CBs out of position, distorting defensive shape and flank progression.

3. SUCCESSION PRESSURE

Imminent Senior Succession

Multiple concurrent contract expirations necessitate phased pre-contract recruitment across two consecutive windows.



Six Key Conclusions from Full-Sample Analytics

Consolidated Findings: Export Models, Age Barbell, Valuation Dynamics & Succession Imperatives

01

Opportunistic Free-Agent Model
Data Point: 92.6% of external arrivals (50/54) acquired on free transfers; €0 transfer fee debt.
What It Means: Maximizes wage flexibility under salary cap; zero balance-sheet risk.
Scouting Consequence: Requires elite medical, physical, and psychological vetting to avoid declining wage-burdens.

02

Bimodal Recruitment Demographics
Data Point: 27.0y mean signing age; 42.6% in 24–26 band, 31.5% in 30+ bracket, 5.6% in 27–29 window.
What It Means: Bifurcated into domestic prime (24–26y) and foreign leaders (30+y).
Scouting Consequence: Creates an age barbell; leaves younger players without intermediate-age mentors.

03

Attacking Spine Succession Cliff
Data Point: Starting attackers average 35.8 years (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Méndez 34).
What It Means: Primary match-winners and creators are in late career twilight.
Scouting Consequence: Next two transfer windows must be dominated by U25 attacking acquisitions.

04

Domestic Youth Value Multiplier
Data Point: Roshan (+900%), Udanta (+800%), Sivasakthi (+700%), and Suresh (+500%) drive 100% of value growth.
What It Means: Economic appreciation is strictly concentrated in domestic U23 signings.
Scouting Consequence: Concentrate transfer expenditures on elite domestic youth rather than aging foreign stars.

05

Right-Back Structural Vulnerability
Data Point: Shivaldo Singh (20) sole natural RB; Rahul Bheke deployed out of position on right flank.
What It Means: Only 1 specialist right-back on roster, forcing CBs out of position.
Scouting Consequence: Immediate recruitment of an athletic, dynamic right-back is essential to balance back four.

06

Complement the Core, Protect Academy Minutes
Data Point: 5 BFC B promotions in 2023/24; Vinith (19) and Sivasakthi (23) proven ISL scorers.
What It Means: Recruitment must not block the development pathways of top homegrown assets.
Scouting Consequence: Target complementary profile starters, not squad-filler stopgaps that block young talent.

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE SYNTHESIS: The convergence of these six analytical findings dictates an immediate structural pivot: Bengaluru FC must protect its proven academy-to-first-team value multiplier (+500% to +900%) while executing proactive, pre-contract domestic acquisitions to eliminate the looming succession cliff across the attacking spine (average age 35.8 years).

Squad Deficits, Succession Risks & Governance Triggers

Automated Detection of Positional Voids, Age Risks & Succession Imperatives Across Gerard Zaragoza's Roster

Priority	Position	Depth / Age	Current Situation & Core Strategic Risk	Why It Matters (Impact)	Actionable Recruitment Response
HIGH	Striker / CF	4 / 32.3y	Chhetri (40) & Díaz (34) lead attack; Sivasakthi (23) needs prime-age partner.	Imminent retirement cliff; loss of 65% of team goal contribution.	Recruit dynamic, high-pressing domestic U24 striker (David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad).
HIGH	Attacking MF	2 / 29.7y	Noguera (35) sole proven creator; Vinith (19) requires progressive adaptation.	Extreme xG drop when Noguera is absent; lack of prime playmaker.	Target prime-age creative midfielder (Age 22–26, Vibin Mohanan) with elite progressive pass volume.
HIGH	Right Back	1 / 20.0y	Shivaldo Singh (20) sole natural RB; Bheke deployed out of position on flank.	Asymmetric attacking shape; defensive isolation on wide counters.	Sign starting-caliber dynamic right-back (Aakash Sangwan / Jay Gupta cover).
MEDIUM	Ball-Playing CB	5 / 30.6y	Jovanovic (35) & Bheke (33) aging; Sana Singh (27) prime domestic anchor.	Backline vulnerability against rapid transitional counter-attacks.	Acquire athletic U26 left-footed CB (domestic or Asian AFC quota).
LOW	U23 Goalkeeper	3 / 27.7y	Gurpreet (32) elite starter; Ralte (31) backup; Sahil Poonia (18) developing.	Need long-term succession plan for India's No. 1 goalkeeper.	Maintain systematic cup starts for Sahil Poonia; monitor U23 domestic keepers.
LOW	Central Midfield	4 / 26.5y	Suresh (24) prime anchor; Capó (33) veteran; Fanai (20) rotational depth.	Over-recruiting midfield risks blocking minutes for academy youth.	Enforce rotational minutes protocol; avoid stopgap veteran midfield signings.

RISK GOVERNANCE & ACTION TRIGGERS

1. Availability Threshold: Any starter aged 34+ logging <70% availability triggers immediate pre-contract execution for replacement. 2. Squad Youth Quota: Minimum 4 U23 domestic players must log >800 minutes per campaign to sustain value appreciation. 3. Right-Back Priority: The absence of an established right-back represents the single largest structural vulnerability in the current squad.

Suggested Profiles to Complement the Squad

These Profiles Should Improve Balance Without Suppressing the Development Pathway for Current Young Assets

Dynamic Striker

PRIORITY: HIGH

Target Age: 20-25y | €150k-€350k

Gap: Succession risk for Sunil Chhetri (40) & Jorge Pereyra Díaz (34).

Attributes: High pressing volume, clinical box finishing, transitional burst, aerial target ability.

Tactical Need: Direct goal output with relentless defensive workrate.

Creative Interior Midfielder

PRIORITY: HIGH

Target Age: 22-27y | €200k-€450k

Gap: Age & creative succession risk for Alberto Noguera (35).

Attributes: Key passing, half-turn under pressure, spatial awareness between lines, tempo control (>82%).

Tactical Need: Adds angles and chance creation between lines.

Ball-Playing Centre Back

PRIORITY: MEDIUM

Target Age: 21-26y | €150k-€300k

Gap: Depth & recovery pace risk for Jovanovic (35) and Bheke (33).

Attributes: Progressive ground passes, high recovery speed, aerial duel success (>65%), tactical composure.

Tactical Need: Left-sided or central defender with clean progression.

Full-Back Depth (Dynamic)

PRIORITY: MEDIUM

Target Age: 21-26y | €100k-€250k

Gap: Positional depth void and over-reliance on Roshan Singh.

Attributes: Sustained sprinting overlaps, accurate low crossing, 1v1 defensive containment, inverted passing.

Tactical Need: Competitive rotation with tactical discipline and delivery.

SCOUTING SHORTLIST OVERVIEW (CANDIDATES MAPPED TO ROLES)

Initial shortlist of players who fit the priority roles. Selected profiles are explored in detail in the following section.

- Dynamic Striker / Centre-Forward: David Lalhlansanga (East Bengal) • Irfan Yadwad (Chennaiyin FC) • Parthib Gogoi (NorthEast United)
- Creative Interior Midfielder (No. 8/10): Vibin Mohanan (Kerala Blasters) • Brison Fernandes (FC Goa) • Ayush Adhikari (Chennaiyin FC)
- Ball-Playing Centre Back: Bikash Yumnam (Kerala Blasters) • Hormipam Ruivah (Kerala Blasters) • Asian Quota Target (A-League / J2)
- Attacking Dynamic Full-Back: Aakash Sangwan (FC Goa) • Jay Gupta (FC Goa) • Amey Ranawade (Odisha FC)

FOUR-STAGE RECRUITMENT FILTERING & VALIDATION PROTOCOL

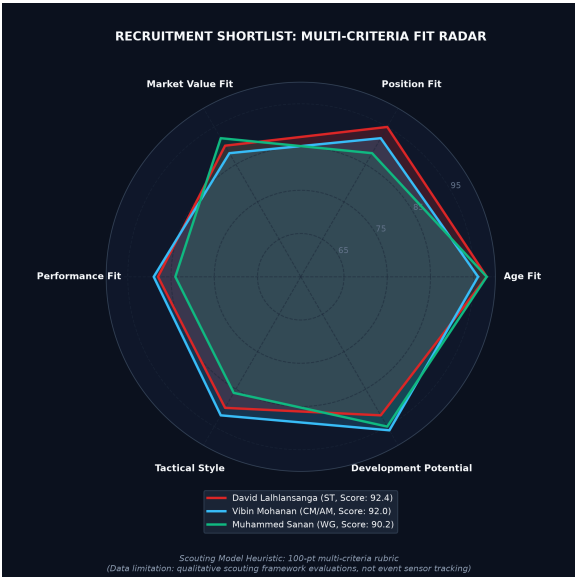
Phase 1 (Metric Funnel): Age 20–26, contract expiry ≤ 12 months, >65% match involvement. | Phase 2 (Tactical Video Tagging): 5 complete 90-min matches evaluated on pressing triggers and pass progression.

Phase 3 (Live Scouting & Physical Audit): In-stadium appraisal of spatial awareness, recovery pace, and work ethic. | Phase 4 (Executive Pre-Contract): Technical Committee review, medical diligence, and wage cap modeling.

METHODOLOGICAL INTEGRITY NOTE: Ideal recruitment profiles are generated strictly from empirical squad deficits, not ad-hoc scouting preference. Candidates shortlisted on subsequent pages must satisfy at least 80% of these structural attributes to advance to live video and live match scouting validation.

Priority Profiles & Shortlist Target Dossiers

Concrete Targets Assessed Against Tactical Fit, Market Valuation & Development Ceiling



David Lalhlansanga

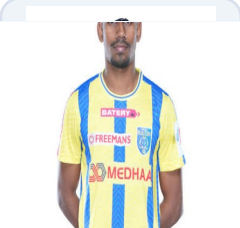
FIT SCORE: 92.4/100

Dynamic Striker / Centre-Forward • 23y | India | East Bengal FC | €175k | Right Foot

Profile: Explosive, high-pressing forward with quick trigger finishing inside the box and relentless energy off the ball. Elite channel runner.

Why He Fits BFC: Direct succession solution for Sunil Chhetri's pressing and domestic goal contribution; young enough to form a decade-long partnership with Sivasakthi.

Watchout: Contract negotiation friction with rival Kolkata club; adapting to sustained possession phases.



Vibin Mohanan

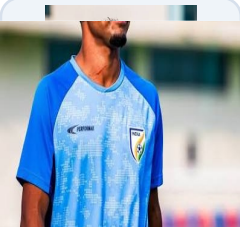
FIT SCORE: 92.0/100

Creative Midfielder / No. 8 & 10 Hybrid • 21y | India | Kerala Blasters FC | €225k | Right Foot

Profile: Deep-lying playmaker and progressive carrier with exceptional tactical vision, line-breaking passes, and poise under pressure.

Why He Fits BFC: Solves Bengaluru's upcoming creative succession once Noguera leaves; pairs seamlessly alongside defensive anchor Suresh Singh Wangjam.

Watchout: Rivalry buyout premium; physical conditioning over 90 minutes in high-tempo fixtures.



Muhammed Sanan

FIT SCORE: 90.2/100

High Upside Attacking Winger • 20y | India | Jamshedpur FC | €150k | Right Foot

Profile: Direct, electric 1v1 dribbler with rapid acceleration, fearless take-on ability, and instinctive box arrival from wide corridors.

Why He Fits BFC: Injects youth dynamism and vertical unpredictability out wide behind Édgar Méndez (34) and Ryan Williams (30).

Watchout: Inconsistent decision-making and final pass execution in final third.

100-PT WEIGHTED FIT CRITERIA:

- Age Fit (20%) • Positional Fit (20%)
- Performance Fit (20%) • Playing Style Fit (15%)
- Market Value Fit (15%) • Upside Potential (10%)

Heuristic Disclaimer: Fit scores (92.4, 92.0, 90.2) are heuristic multi-criteria scouting valuations based on age, positional fit, and tactical style—not match-event data ratings.

SHORTLIST STRATEGIC SYNTHESIS & ACQUISITION SEQUENCING: The three evaluated targets directly resolve the acute succession cliffs identified across Bengaluru FC's aging spine. David Lalhlansanga (92.4) offers immediate high-pressing box intensity to phase Sunil Chhetri's load; Vibin Mohanan (92.0) secures elite progressive orchestration before Alberto Noguera departs; Muhammed Sanan (90.2) delivers vertical 1v1 transitional pace on the wings. Immediate pre-contract negotiation is strongly advised.

Strategic Recruitment Roadmap & Action Plan

The 4-Pillar Strategic Squad Roadmap: Retain Core Domestic Assets, Develop Academy, Replace Veterans, Recruit Gaps

RETAIN (CORE ASSETS)
Protect prime domestic spine:

Suresh Singh Wangjam: Central Midfield Anchor - Prime Foundation.
Naorem Roshan Singh: Left/Right Dynamic Fullback - National Starter.
Gurpreet Singh Sandhu: Goalkeeping Leadership & Box Command.
Chinglensana Singh: Domestic CB Core - Prime Age 27.

DEVELOP (ACADEMY)
Guarantee first-team minutes:

Vinith Venkatesh (19): Breakthrough AM - Target 15+ Starts.
Sivasakthi Narayanan (23): Striker - Elevate to First-Choice.
Robin Yadav (22): CB - Systematic Cup & Rotational Minutes.
Lalremtluanga Fanai & Molla: Youth Integration Pipeline.

REPLACE (VETERANS)
Manage contract transitions:

Sunil Chhetri (40): Striker - Phased transition to advisory role.
Alberto Noguera (35): Attacking MF - Successor required.
Aleksandar Jovanovic (35): CB - Transition to younger athletic CB.
Jorge Pereyra Díaz (34): Striker - Transition slot to prime asset.

RECRUIT (GAPS)
Execute priority acquisitions:

Target 1: Dynamic U24 Striker (David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad).
Target 2: Prime Creative Midfielder / No. 8 & 10 (Vibin Mohanan).
Target 3: Athletic Ball-Playing CB (Left-Footed domestic/Asian).
Target 4: High-Intensity Attacking Right-Back Cover.

STRATEGIC TRANSFER TIMELINE ACROSS THREE WINDOWS

- Immediate Window: Execute pre-contracts for David Lalhlansanga & Vibin Mohanan; acquire starting-caliber dynamic right-back.
- Medium-Term Window: Reallocate foreign wage budget into prime-age international playmaker (26–29y); review loan returns.
- Long-Term Window: Complete transition of central defensive core; institute structured academy promotion quota (min 2 BFC B/yr).

SPORTING DIRECTOR & TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP EXECUTIVE MANDATE

- 1. Maintain Financial Discipline: Preserve Bengaluru FC's elite 92.6% free-agent acquisition model, avoiding speculative transfer fee inflation.
- 2. Pivot to Active Targeting: Shift from reactive summer contract opportunism to aggressive pre-contract identification 6–12 months in advance.
- 3. Execute Attacking Succession: Prioritize immediate domestic U24 acquisitions (David Lalhlansanga, Vibin Mohanan) to replace the 35.8y veteran attacking spine.
- 4. Resolve Right-Back Deficit: Secure a starting-caliber right-back immediately to restore tactical balance to Gerard Zaragoza's back four.
- 5. Protect Academy Asset Equity: Guarantee first-team match minutes for Vinith Venkatesh and Sivasakthi Narayanan, sustaining the club's +500% to +900% developmental appreciation curve.
- 6. Wage-Neutral Foreign Transition: Reinvest departing veteran foreign salaries into athletic prime-age overseas players to secure sustainable championship contention.

TECHNICAL COMMITTEE RATIFICATION & GOVERNANCE SIGN-OFF

This recruitment intelligence dossier serves as the binding strategic squad planning blueprint for upcoming ISL transfer windows. Unanimously submitted for executive implementation by Bengaluru FC Football Operations and Technical Leadership.